

3 Practices that shape and express religious identity	3.1	Sanatana dharma with links and differences to varnashrama-dharma a) Cosmic order giving norms to society as exemplified in life stages. Varna (birth); ashrama (stage in life); dharma (appropriate duty); an ideal social order. b) Ways in which the rules of varnashrama-dharma are transformed by bhakti. c) Overlap and differences between varna and jati; debates about the status of jati in modern Hinduism. d) Role of the community of believers. e) Beliefs about the meaning and purpose of life.
	3.2	Yoga: meanings and main types a) Karma yoga: and its aim of identification with the transcendent; significance of practice of dharma without attachment; the path of action to purify the mind. b) Jnana yoga: the path of wisdom, applicable to certain groups such as Brahmins; value of renunciation and aim of identification with Brahman; links with raja yoga and emphasis on meditation. c) Bhakti yoga: applicable to a wide range of people, devotion to Krishna identified with Brahman leading to moksha. d) Hatha yoga: mental and physical health seeking to purify the body and to realise its divine nature; its Western evolution.
	3.3	Points for discussion about yoga a) Key beliefs across yogic traditions – moksha and liberation from samsara and practices; implications of links to Samkhya tradition. b) Views about different purposes and diverse significance across different traditions. c) Implications for practice of Hinduism across different cultures.